

## FOR THE TEACHER

# Teacher Guide & Answer Key

Hallucination Hunters — every planted error with the true fact, verdict guidance, fact-desk coaching, and the standards map.



## WHY THIS LESSON

Every AI job runs **human** → **AI** → **human**: a person starts it (the prompt) and a person ends it (the check). This lesson trains the second human job. The core insight students leave with: AI predicts *likely* words, not *verified* words — so smoothness is zero evidence of truth. Lateral reading (leave the answer, confirm against a second, independent source) is the same move professional fact-checkers make, and it works on AI answers, group-chat rumors, and feeds alike.

## RUNNING THE FACT DESK

**Play the managing editor**, not the answer key. When a desk asks "is this one true?", answer "that's a checkable claim — where's your second source?" Keep deadline energy: "Presses roll in five!"

**Watch for the two failure modes.** The trusting desk clears everything ("it sounded right") — send them back to step 1: did you underline the dates and names? The paranoid desk kills everything ("it's all sus") — that's what RANK is for: check what would hurt most. The goal is calibrated skepticism, not panic.

**The fabricated quote in Draft #3 is the boss level.** Many students treat quotation marks as proof. Desk rule: a quote is a claim — no traceable source, no print.

## ANSWER KEY — WARM-UP PARAGRAPH (READ-ALoud)

| PLANTED ERROR                                                        | THE TRUE FACT                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| "The closest planet to the Sun is Venus, which is also the hottest." | <b>Mercury</b> is closest to the Sun. Venus really is the hottest (its thick atmosphere traps heat) — the half-truth is what makes this one slippery. |
| "Saturn... is the only planet in our solar system that has [rings]." | Jupiter, Uranus, and Neptune also have rings — faint ones. Saturn's are just the most visible.                                                        |

*True claims a desk should mark SAFE or confirm:* eight planets; Mars is red from rusty iron dust on its surface; sunlight takes about eight minutes to reach Earth.

## ANSWER KEY — THE THREE DRAFTS (EVERY PLANTED ERROR)

| DRAFT     | PLANTED ERROR                                                | THE TRUE FACT                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| #1 Priya  | "Astronauts first landed on the Moon in 1959"                | The first crewed Moon landing was Apollo 11, in <b>1969</b> .                                                                                   |
| #1 Priya  | "the Moon... produces its own light"                         | The Moon makes no light of its own — it <b>reflects sunlight</b> .                                                                              |
| #2 Theo   | "Mount Everest... rises in the Andes range in South America" | Everest is in the <b>Himalayas, in Asia</b> . The Andes are in South America.                                                                   |
| #2 Theo   | "Australia's capital city is Sydney"                         | The capital is <b>Canberra</b> ; Sydney is the largest city. A classic mix-up.                                                                  |
| #3 Marcus | "Thomas Edison invented the telephone in 1876"               | <b>Alexander Graham Bell</b> patented the telephone in 1876. Edison's fame: the phonograph and practical electric lighting.                     |
| #3 Marcus | Quote: "The telephone is the finest of all my inventions."   | <b>Fabricated</b> — written for this exercise; it has no source. AI generates real-sounding quotes nobody said. No traceable source = no print. |

*True claims, safe to confirm:* #1 — the Moon is Earth's only natural satellite; Neil Armstrong walked first; twelve people have walked on the Moon. #2 — Pacific is the largest ocean; the Nile flows north through Egypt, one of the world's longest rivers; seven continents; Asia is the largest. #3 — the phonograph (1877) was the first machine to both record and play back sound; the Wright brothers flew in 1903 near Kitty Hawk, North Carolina.

**Verdict guidance:** Draft #1 — **FIX** (topic holds; correct the date and the light claim). Draft #2 — **FIX** (correct the range and the capital). Draft #3 — **KILL** (headline claim false, supporting quote fabricated — no story left to fix). No draft earns RUN today; tell the class that's realistic. A well-argued FIX on #3 ("rewrite it about Bell") earns credit for evidence — then ask: is that a fix, or a new story? Score the evidence, not the stamp: proficient desks name the claim, the correction, and a second source.

## FULL STANDARDS TEXT

- **CCSS ELA RI.6.8** — Trace and evaluate the argument and specific claims in a text, distinguishing claims that are supported by reasons and evidence from claims that are not. *Taught: fact-desk method steps 1–2, modeled on the warm-up. Assessed: underlines, C/S marks, and verdict notes on all three drafts.*
- **ISTE 1.3.b** — Students evaluate the accuracy, perspective, credibility and relevance of information, media, data or other resources. *Taught: lateral reading, step 3. Assessed: "Second source" columns + Exit Ticket #2.*
- **ISTE 1.3.d** — Students build knowledge by actively exploring real-world issues and problems, developing ideas and theories and pursuing answers and solutions. *Taught: The Fact Desk activity — desks pursue verification, defend verdicts in the stand-up. Assessed: Exit Ticket #2 (a real claim from their week) + stand-up evidence.*

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